PHISHSCOPE

Incident Investigation Report

Account security phishing

1cf5d344-7092-4108-8f77-17aa4bc82a86

CRITICAL / 100 of 100

SIMULATION - Synthetic email evidence

Classification: CONFIDENTIAL

Analyst: SOC Analyst

Generated: 2026-11-05T09:37:05.905161+00:00

Executive Summary

Account security phishing: CRITICAL, score 100/100. 10 local findings and 16 indicators. No evidence of successful compromise.

SIMULATION: synthetic reserved-domain evidence.

Incident Identification

ID: 1cf5d344-7092-4108-8f77-17aa4bc82a86

Created: 2026-11-05T09:03:48.594419+00:00

Analysis revision: 96d20c20-dea1-4d05-a0c7-942a9078308c

Analyst: SOC Analyst

Organization: Local SOC workspace

Incident Description

Subject: Urgent: verify your account or face suspension

SIMULATION ONLY. Verify your password immediately at https://verify-account.example/login

Investigation Scope

Static examination of supplied email bytes, headers, MIME parts and text. External lookups are opt-in and recorded separately. Endpoint, mailbox and identity telemetry are outside scope.

Email Metadata

Field	Value
sender	Microsoft Security <security@verify-account.example>
recipient	Analyst <analyst@company.example>
reply_to	help@support-desk.example
subject	Urgent: verify your account or face suspension
date	Thu, 05 Nov 2026 09:00:00 +0000
message_id	<account@simulation.example>

Email Header Analysis

Header	Value
From	Microsoft Security <security@verify-account.example>
To	Analyst <analyst@company.example>
Subject	Urgent: verify your account or face suspension

Header	Value
Date	Thu, 05 Nov 2026 09:00:00 +0000
Message-ID	<account@simulation.example>
Received	from mail.simulation.example ([192.0.2.25]) by gateway.company.example; Thu, 05 Nov 2026 09:00:00 +0000
Authentication-Results	gateway.company.example; spf=fail; dkim=fail; dmarc=fail
X-PhishScope-Simulation	true
Reply-To	help@support-desk.example
MIME-Version	1.0
Content-Type	multipart/alternative; boundary="==========9116293316748303178=="

Authentication Analysis

Method	Result	Evidence trust
SPF	fail	Reported by supplied headers; header provenance is not independently verified.
DKIM	fail	Reported by supplied headers; header provenance is not independently verified.
DMARC	fail	Reported by supplied headers; header provenance is not independently verified.

Technical Findings

F001: Reply-To domain differs from sender. Evidence: From: Microsoft Security <security@verify-account.example>; Reply-To: help@support-desk.example. Interpretation: Replies would be delivered to a different registrable domain; legitimate workflows can also do this.

F002: Brand impersonation indicator. Evidence: Microsoft Security <security@verify-account.example>. Interpretation: Display name claims a recognized brand while the sender uses another domain. Delegated senders remain possible.

F003: SPF reported fail. Evidence: gateway.company.example; spf=fail; dkim=fail; dmarc=fail. Interpretation: The supplied Authentication-Results header explicitly reports this result; it may be forged.

F004: DKIM reported fail. Evidence: gateway.company.example; spf=fail; dkim=fail; dmarc=fail. Interpretation: The supplied Authentication-Results header explicitly reports this result; it may be forged.

F005: DMARC reported fail. Evidence: gateway.company.example; spf=fail; dkim=fail; dmarc=fail. Interpretation: The supplied Authentication-Results header explicitly reports this result; it may be forged.

F006: Pressure and urgency language. Evidence: Urgent, immediately. Interpretation: Time pressure can encourage a recipient to bypass verification.

F007: Potential credential request. Evidence: SIMULATION ONLY. Verify your password immediately at https://verify-account.example/login

SIMULATION ONLY. Urgent: verify your account password to prevent suspension. https://microsoft.example/security hidden link. Interpretation: Message requests account or credential interaction; credential theft is a hypothesis, not a confirmed outcome.

F008: Link text disguises destination. Evidence: Displayed: https://microsoft.example/security; actual: https://verify-account.example/login?redirect=https%3A%2F%2Flanding.example. Interpretation: Visible link text and destination hostnames differ.

F009: Hidden HTML link. Evidence: https://hidden.example/track. Interpretation: The link or an ancestor has a hiding style or hidden attribute.

F010: External redirect target in URL. Evidence: https://verify-account.example/login?redirect=https%3A%2F%2Flanding.example -> https://landing.example. Interpretation: A URL-valued redirect parameter is present; actual server behavior is unverified.

Indicators of Compromise

Type	Indicator	Source / reason
url	https://hidden.example/track	HTML href: Extracted from original evidence
domain	hidden.example	HTML href: Extracted from original evidence
url	https://verify-account.example/login?redirect=https%3A%2F%2Flanding.example	HTML href: Extracted from original evidence
domain	verify-account.example	HTML href: Extracted from original evidence
url	https://landing.example	Redirect query metadata: Embedded redirect target; not fetched or confirmed
domain	landing.example	Redirect query metadata: Extracted from original evidence
url	https://verify-account.example/login	Email text: Extracted from original evidence
email	security@verify-account.example	Headers/body: Extracted from original evidence
email	analyst@company.example	Headers/body: Extracted from original evidence
domain	company.example	Email address: Extracted from original evidence
email	account@simulation.example	Headers/body: Extracted from original evidence
domain	simulation.example	Email address: Extracted from original evidence
email	help@support-desk.example	Headers/body: Extracted from original evidence
domain	support-desk.example	Email address: Extracted from original evidence
ipv4	192.0.2.25	Headers/body: Extracted from original evidence
domain	microsoft.example	Body text: Extracted from original evidence

Threat Intelligence Results

No external intelligence lookup has been completed. Local heuristic assessment - not externally verified.

MITRE ATT&CK Mapping

T1566 Phishing / Initial Access / suspected / confidence medium. Evidence: ["F001", "F002", "F003", "F004", " F005", "F006", "F007", "F008", "F009", "F010"]. Multiple local indicators are consistent with a phishing attempt; attribution and intent remain unverified. Source: https://attack.mitre.org/techniques/T1566/

T1566.002 Spearphishing Link / Initial Access / suspected / confidence medium. Evidence: ["https://verify-account.example/login", "https://verify-account.example/login?redirect=https%3A%2F%2Flanding.example", "https://hidden.example/track"]. Links occur in a message with corroborating suspicious findings. Source: https://attack.mitre.org/techniques/T1566/002/

Risk and Severity Assessment

Score: 100/100; severity: critical; confidence: medium.

Sum of unique local risk factors, capped at 100. Thresholds are application-defined: 0-24 low, 25-49 medium, 50-74 high, 75-100 critical.

Reply-To domain differs from sender: +15. Replies would be delivered to a different registrable domain; legitimate workflows can also do this. Evidence: From: Microsoft Security <security@verify-account.example>; Reply-To: help@support-desk.example

Brand impersonation indicator: +15. Display name claims a recognized brand while the sender uses another domain. Delegated senders remain possible. Evidence: Microsoft Security <security@verify-account.example>

SPF reported fail: +8. The supplied Authentication-Results header explicitly reports this result; it may be forged. Evidence: gateway.company.example; spf=fail; dkim=fail; dmarc=fail

DKIM reported fail: +8. The supplied Authentication-Results header explicitly reports this result; it may be forged. Evidence: gateway.company.example; spf=fail; dkim=fail; dmarc=fail

DMARC reported fail: +12. The supplied Authentication-Results header explicitly reports this result; it may be forged. Evidence: gateway.company.example; spf=fail; dkim=fail; dmarc=fail

Pressure and urgency language: +10. Time pressure can encourage a recipient to bypass verification. Evidence: Urgent, immediately

Potential credential request: +12. Message requests account or credential interaction; credential theft is a hypothesis, not a confirmed outcome. Evidence: SIMULATION ONLY. Verify your password immediately at https://verify-account.example/login

SIMULATION ONLY. Urgent: verify your account password to prevent suspension. https://microsoft.example/security hidden link

Link text disguises destination: +15. Visible link text and destination hostnames differ. Evidence: Displayed: https://microsoft.example/security; actual: https://verify-account.example/login?redirect=https%3A%2F%2Flanding.example

Hidden HTML link: +8. The link or an ancestor has a hiding style or hidden attribute. Evidence: https://hidden.example/track

External redirect target in URL: +8. A URL-valued redirect parameter is present; actual server behavior is unverified. Evidence: https://verify-account.example/login?redirect=https%3A%2F%2Flanding.example -> https://landing.example

Evidence Register

E001: Original email, SHA-256 888cc91a26729ce3589e710751da2869c73d67f6eda0283b9554a40b623e4feb; preserved exact bytes.

Analyst notes: None recorded.

Incident Response Recommendations

Preparation: Review email authentication enforcement and awareness training. Observed anomalies provide concrete examples for control review. Finding references: F001, F002, F003, F004, F005, F006, F007, F008, F009, F010

Containment: Quarantine this message for review and identify other recipients before taking broader action. Local findings warrant triage; unverified infrastructure should not be automatically blocked. Finding references: F001, F002, F003, F004, F005, F006, F007, F008, F009, F010

Eradication: After validation, remove matching confirmed malicious messages. Preserve original evidence and confirm scope first. Finding references: F001, F002, F003, F004, F005, F006, F007, F008, F009, F010

Recovery: Ask whether the recipient interacted; reset credentials only if exposure is established. The email alone contains no evidence of compromise. Finding references: F001, F002, F003, F004, F005, F006, F007, F008, F009, F010

Lessons Learned: Document verified patterns and review matching detection rules. Use evidence-backed patterns while recording false-positive possibilities. Finding references: F001, F002, F003, F004, F005, F006, F007, F008, F009, F010

Investigation Timeline

2026-11-05T09:03:48.594419+00:00: Evidence submitted.

2026-11-05T09:03:48.596803+00:00: Local analysis revision 96d20c20-dea1-4d05-a0c7-942a9078308c.

2026-11-05T09:32:57.557942+00:00: pdf report exported (revision 96d20c20-dea1-4d05-a0c7-942a9078308c).

2026-11-05T09:30:27.129707+00:00: pdf report exported (revision 96d20c20-dea1-4d05-a0c7-942a9078308c).

2026-11-05T09:03:49.035795+00:00: pdf report exported (revision 96d20c20-dea1-4d05-a0c7-942a9078308c).

2026-11-05T09:37:05.905380+00:00: Report prepared.

Limitations and Unverified Findings

Local heuristic assessment - not externally verified.

Authentication-Results headers can be forged; their receiving gateway provenance is unverified.

No URLs were fetched, redirects followed, DNS lookups performed, or attachments executed.

No click, execution, credential exposure or successful compromise is established.

Sender/domain reputation is unknown until an explicit external lookup; lack of detections does not establish safety.

Conclusion

Critical local email risk assessment. No evidence of successful compromise. Validate suspicious indicators before blocking infrastructure or applying account remediation.

References

MITRE Enterprise ATT&CK: https://attack.mitre.org/

https://attack.mitre.org/techniques/T1566/

https://attack.mitre.org/techniques/T1566/002/

PhishScope local rule engine 1.0.0. Thresholds are application-defined; this report is not a breach determination.